Storyboard and the limits of simulation

We used a storyboard to make the proposed service sequence concrete. Its ending is an intended experience, not an observed guest outcome.



Fig. A10. Our six-scene pre-arrival storyboard. Original illustration; undated in the supplied archive.

What we tried to make explicit

Scene	The service hypothesis inside it
Guest → assistant	A conversation establishes travel intent and known routines; the assistant may contribute additional context.
Assistant → interface	Visible options could make possible arrangements easier to recognise and express.
Submission	The assistant can communicate a useful brief without excessive effort.
Hotel confirmation	The hotel distinguishes what can and cannot be arranged before the assistant reports back.
Arrival interaction	A Dream Maker may notice something the pre-arrival brief did not contain. The original scene leaves the method "TBD".
Room encounter	The guest feels appropriately recognised by the preparation and care received. This was the desired ending.

What we can say about the walkthrough

We had only a simple simulated test of the design. We did not recruit real assistants or hotel staff to complete the final service tasks. The archive does not supply a reliable task-level record of timings, misunderstandings or actions that could not be executed.

The storyboard makes assumptions visible: the assistant will engage, a request will reach a decision-maker, arrival contact will be available and the hotel can fulfil the plan. It does not show that those assumptions held.

For a next test we would include refusal, no additional need, unavailable capacity and a late change, then record both the user experience and the complete staff workload. This is a proposed test, not one already conducted.